
North Coast Regional Water Quality Control Board

March 13, 2017

Parlin Fork Conservation Camp
Cal Fire
Attn: Bob Faris, Division Chief
23000 Highway 20
Fort Bragg, CA 95437

Dear Mr. Faris:

Subject: Cal Fire Parlin Fork Conservation Camp Wastewater Treatment System, Fort Bragg, Mendocino County – Notice of Applicability of Water Quality Order WQ 2014-0153-DWQ

File: CDF Parlin Fork Conservation Camp, 23000 Highway 20, Fort Bragg, CA; WDID No. 1B77108OMEN; CIWQS Place No. 213604

This letter serves as Notice of Applicability (NOA) from the North Coast Regional Water Quality Control Board (Regional Water Board) that the General Waste Discharge Requirements for Small Domestic Wastewater Treatment Systems, Order WQ 2014-0153-DWQ (General Order) is applicable to the subject wastewater system and that the system is henceforth regulated under the General Order as described below. A Monitoring and Reporting Program (MRP) for the wastewater system is included as an enclosure of this NOA.

Cal Fire submitted a report of waste discharge (ROWD) dated June 25, 2015, for the use of a domestic wastewater treatment system serving the Cal Fire Parlin Fork Conservation Camp located at 23000 Highway 20, Fort Bragg in Mendocino County. Based on the information presented in the ROWD, the wastewater treatment system and discharge are consistent with the requirements of the General Order.

The General Order contains requirements that apply to all wastewater systems and also requirements that apply only to specific types of treatment and/or disposal systems. Applicable requirements are discussed in Section 3 of the NOA and summarized in Table 1, an enclosure of this NOA. The General Order contains additional requirements that are not summarized in Table 1. The Discharger is responsible for all applicable requirements in the General Order, this NOA, and the MRP.

A copy of the General Order is enclosed with this NOA. The General Order is also available on the Internet at:

http://www.waterboards.ca.gov/board_decisions/adopted_orders/water_quality/2014/wqo2014_0153_dwq.pdf

1. Facility and Discharge Description

Facility

The Cal Fire Parlin Fork Conservation Camp (Facility) is owned by Cal Fire (Discharger) and is located adjacent to Parlin Creek in the Jackson Demonstration Forest east of Fort Bragg. The Discharger operates the Facility wastewater treatment system. The California Department of Corrections and Rehabilitation oversees the operation of the on-site inmate conservation camp. Approximately 100 minimum custody inmates reside at the Facility and approximately 20 staff members are employed there. The Facility is not located in an area served by a regional wastewater collection system; therefore, domestic wastewater is collected and treated on-site. The site location is shown on Attachment A, which is attached hereto and is made part of this NOA by reference.

The Facility is located on two 640-acre parcels. The conservation camp buildings, grease interceptor, septic tanks, and one lift station are located along the northern boundary of parcel APN No. 021-030-10. The lower leachfield, former wastewater pond, and second lift station are located in the southwest corner of parcel APN No. 021-030-04 and the upper leachfield is located near the western boundary.

Wastewater originating from Facility restrooms, showers, kitchen, and laundry facilities is treated and disposed of via the on-site domestic wastewater treatment system. The current wastewater system was installed in 1998 as required by Cease and Desist Order (CDO) No. 98-38 to correct violations of Waste Discharge Requirements (WDR) Order No. 97-52. CDO No. 98-38 was issued on March 26, 1998, due to on-going instances of surfacing effluent from the lower leachfield.

WDR Order No. 97-52 authorized the discharge of treated wastewater from the percolation/evaporation pond and the lower leachfield that received pond overflow. Following installation of the current wastewater system in 1998, the wastewater pond was periodically used in emergency pump failure situations when wastewater was sent by gravity to the pond rather than pumped uphill to the upper leachfield. In 2016, Cal Fire removed the wastewater pond by draining the water to the lower leachfield and backfilling the pond with soil. Removal of the pond caused the lower leachfield to disconnect from the existing wastewater collection system. The lower leachfield remains in place and Cal Fire is considering possible future use of it during emergency pump failure situations. On August 26, 2016, Regional Water Board staff directed Cal Fire to submit a report of waste discharge for review prior to approval of this proposed emergency use.

The current wastewater system serving the Facility consists of a gravity collection system, grease interceptor, bar screen, two 10,000-gallon septic tanks, two lift stations, a 1,000-gallon septic tank, and a subsurface disposal field.

Discharge Description

The Facility wastewater treatment system is designed for an average daily flow of 14,200 gallons per day (gpd). As described in the ROWD, the projected untreated and treated domestic wastewater quality from the Facility is consistent with the characterization of wastewater in the General Order.

The overall plan layout of the wastewater collection system is included as attachments to a Department of Forestry and Fire Protection letter dated April 16, 1998, and a Cal Fire email dated January 10, 2016. The letter, email and attachments are part of this NOA by reference.

Primary Treatment and Collection System

Primary waste treatment and collection will be provided using a kitchen grease interceptor, septic tanks, gravity collection system and lift stations, as described below.

A 1,500-gallon grease interceptor serves the kitchen of the mess hall building. The Discharger pumps the interceptor twice a year. Wastewater passing through the interceptor is combined with other Facility wastewater and directed to a bar screen for removal of large solids and debris. After passing through the bar screen the wastewater is directed to one of two 10,000-gallon septic tanks for primary treatment. The Discharger pumps solids from the two septic tanks annually.

Following primary treatment in the septic tanks wastewater enters into an adjacent lift station (Lift Station 1). Wastewater is then pumped from Lift Station 1 across a bridge and uphill to a second lift station (Lift Station 2). Lift Station 2 is located adjacent to the footprint of the former wastewater pond. Wastewater is pumped from Lift Station 2 uphill to a septic tank and the upper leachfield.

Both lift stations are equipped with duplex pumps and float switches that are controlled and monitored by an adjacent pump control panel with visual and audible alarms. A flow meter at Lift Station 1 measures the volume of wastewater sent to the upper leachfield.

Wastewater Discharge System

Following primary treatment, wastewater will be disposed of at the upper leachfield, located in the area of a former orchard. Wastewater pumped to the upper leachfield septic tank by Lift Station 2 is directed via a distribution box to one of two branches of the upper leachfield. The lineal length of the upper leachfield is approximately 5,300 feet. The northern most branch consists of 2,600 feet of leach line and 200 feet of infiltrator chambers. The southern branch consists of 2,300 feet of leach line and 200 feet of infiltrator chambers. The leachfield is designed to dispose of 14,200 gpd of wastewater with an application rate of 0.6 gallons/square foot/day. The Discharger identified a 100 percent reserve disposal field area in the same area, directly adjacent to the upper leachfield. The disposal field, reserve area, and treatment system components meet the setback requirements in the General Order.

General WDR Order Coverage

Commencing on the date of this NOA, waste discharges from the Facility's domestic wastewater treatment system are regulated under the General Order (Order WQ 2014-0153-DWQ).

2. California Environmental Quality Act

The Parlin Fork Conservation Camp domestic wastewater discharge covered under the General Order is exempt pursuant to California Code of Regulations, title 14, section 15301 (ongoing or existing projects). The Facility is an existing wastewater treatment facility with no expansion of use or wastewater flow beyond existing uses and beyond existing design capacity. The Facility is located in a rural area where other facilities and dischargers of the same type are not expected over time.

3. Site-Specific Requirements and Effluent Limitations

A. General

The General Order contains prohibitions and specifications that apply to all wastewater systems covered under the General Order, and specifications that apply only to specific types of treatment and/or disposal systems. Table 1 of this NOA provides a summary of applicable discharge requirements for the subject wastewater system. Discharge of wastes other than those described in the ROWD is prohibited.

Wastewater system managers and operators must be familiar with the applicable requirements contained in the General Order, this NOA, and MRP R1-2017-0009.

B. Reports to be submitted to the Regional Water Board

1. The following technical reports, which form the main components of a comprehensive Operation, Maintenance, and Monitoring program, shall be submitted as described below:
 - a) By June 12, 2017, the Discharger shall submit a Spill Prevention and Emergency Response Plan (Response Plan) consistent with the requirements of General Order Provision E.1.a. The Response Plan shall, at a minimum, address the following:
 - 1) Operation and Control of Wastewater Treatment
 - 2) Sludge Handling
 - 3) Collection System Maintenance
 - 4) Emergency Response
 - 5) Notification Procedures
 - b) By June 12, 2017, the Discharger shall submit a Sampling and Analysis Plan consistent with the requirements of General Order Provision E.1.b.
2. The above reports shall be acceptable to the Regional Water Board Executive Officer.

C. Septic Tanks

The domestic wastewater system serving the Facility includes septic tanks that provide primary treatment of the wastewater. Septic tanks require proper operation, maintenance, and monitoring in order to provide adequate and reliable wastewater service. This includes periodic inspection and removal, as needed, of accumulated solids. Requirements for septic tanks are included in General Order section B.2, Septic Systems, and in the enclosed MRP, at section titled "Septic Tank Monitoring and Maintenance." Qualified service providers shall conduct operational maintenance and monitoring work on the septic systems with appropriate oversight by the Discharger. The Discharger is responsible for ensuring proper operation, maintenance, and monitoring of all septic tanks.

D. Subsurface Disposal System Requirements

The wastewater system includes dispersal of treated effluent to subsurface soil via a 5,300 lineal foot leachfield disposal system. The Discharger is required to maintain the capacity of the disposal system to handle 100 percent of the design wastewater flows and to maintain a reserve disposal area with an additional 100-percent capacity. The reserve area is for future use, in case the existing disposal system is found to be inadequate. The reserve area is required to remain available until needed. The Discharger has designated a reserve disposal area adjacent to the existing upper leachfield.

4. Monitoring and Reporting Program

The Discharger shall comply with enclosed MRP R1-2017-0009, for the Parlin Fork Conservation Camp Wastewater Treatment System, which is part of this NOA by reference.

The MRP includes requirements for the monitoring and maintenance of the septic tanks, lift stations and leachfield.

The Discharger shall submit quarterly self-monitoring reports and an annual summary report to the Regional Water Board in accordance with the Table 6 of the MRP. The Discharger shall consult the MRP for all specific requirements.

5. Enforcement

The Discharger shall manage and discharge the waste subject to the terms and conditions of the General Order and this NOA and shall maintain exclusive control over the discharges. As such, the Discharger is responsible for compliance with the General Order and this NOA.

Failure to comply with the requirements in the General Order, this NOA, or the MRP could result in an enforcement action as authorized by provisions of the California Water Code.

California Water Code section 13267 states, in part:

"In conducting an investigation specified in subdivision (a), the regional board may require that any person who has discharged, discharges, or is suspected of having discharged or discharging, or who proposes to discharge waste within its region, or any citizen or domiciliary, or political agency or entity of this state who has discharged,

discharges, or is suspected of having discharged or discharging, or who proposes to discharge, waste outside of its region that could affect the quality of waters within its region shall furnish, under penalty of perjury, technical or monitoring program reports which the regional board requires. The burden, including costs, of these reports shall bear a reasonable relationship to the need for the report and the benefits to be obtained from the reports. In requiring those reports, the regional board shall provide the person with a written explanation with regard to the need for the reports, and shall identify the evidence that supports requiring that person to provide the reports.”

California Water Code section 13268 states, in part:

“(a) Any person failing or refusing to furnish technical or monitoring program reports as required by subdivision (b) of section 13267, or failing or refusing to furnish a statement of compliance as required by subdivision (b) of section 13399.2, or falsifying any information provided therein, is guilty of a misdemeanor and may be liable civilly in accordance with subdivision (b).

(b)(1) Civil liability may be administratively imposed by a regional board in accordance with article 2.5 (commencing with section 13323) of chapter 5 for a violation of subdivision (a) in an amount which shall not exceed one thousand dollars (\$1,000) for each day in which the violation occurs.”

The reports required in item 3.B are necessary to ensure that the Discharger complies with the NOA and General Order. The burden, including costs, of these reports bears a reasonable relationship to the need for the reports and the benefits to be obtained from the reports. Pursuant to California Water Code section 13267, the Discharger shall submit the reports described herein.

Please review this NOA carefully to ensure that it completely and accurately reflects the discharge. If the discharge violates the terms or conditions listed, the Regional Water Board may take enforcement action, including assessment of administrative civil liability. Prior to allowing changes to the wastewater strength or generation rate, or if the method of waste discharge changes from that described in the ROWD, you must contact the Regional Water Board to determine if submittal of a ROWD is required.

6. Annual Fees

The waste discharge authorized by this NOA is subject to payment of annual fees under the State Water Board’s annual fee schedule for regulated discharges. Annual fees are based in part on ratings for threat to water quality and complexity. The subject Facility is currently rated 3-C. The annual fee for this rating in accordance with the current (FY 2016-2017) Fee Schedule is \$2,088; however, based on the flow rate, the discharge qualifies for the 50-percent fee discount. The annual fee for the discharge is currently \$1,044.

The Fee Schedule is subject to change, and the fee for this Facility may change accordingly. Annual fees are due and payable as invoiced annually to the Discharger by the State Water Board.

7. Regional Water Board Contact Information

Regulation of the subject domestic wastewater treatment system under the General Order is managed by the Regional Water Board Groundwater Permitting Unit. The case is currently assigned to Regional Water Board staff environmental scientist Rachel Prat. Questions or concerns about this NOA, the attached MRP, or related matters should be directed to Rachel Prat at (707) 576-2542 or Rachel.Prat@waterboards.ca.gov.

Sincerely,

Matthias St. John
Executive Officer

170313_RSP_dp_ParlinFork_WWTF_NOA

Attachments:

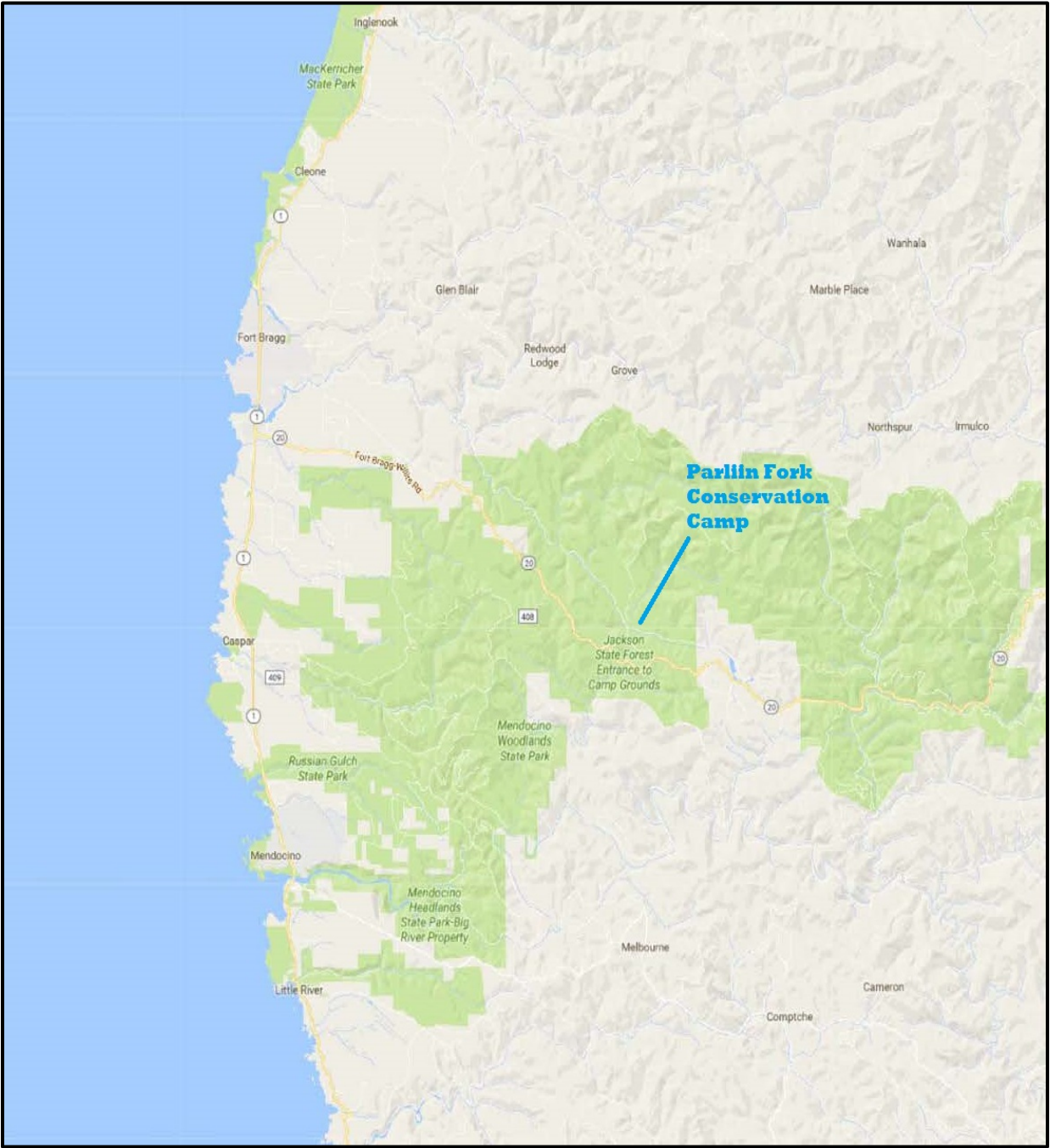
Attachment A, Site Location Map
Attachment B, Project Area Map
Attachment C, Wastewater Treatment System Schematic

Enclosures:

Table 1, Summary of Applicable Discharge Requirements
Water Quality Order WQ 2014-0153-DWQ
Monitoring and Reporting Program R1-2017-0009

cc Chris Almind, Cal Fire, Parlin Fork Conservation Camp, Fort Bragg,
Chris.Almind@fire.ca.gov
Rob Daugherty, Cal Fire, Parlin Fork Conservation Camp, Fort Bragg,
Rob.Daugherty@fire.ca.gov
Valerie Aura, Mendocino County Land Use Program, Fort Bragg,
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Attachment A – Site Location Map



Attachment B – Project Area Map



Attachment C – Wastewater Treatment System Schematic

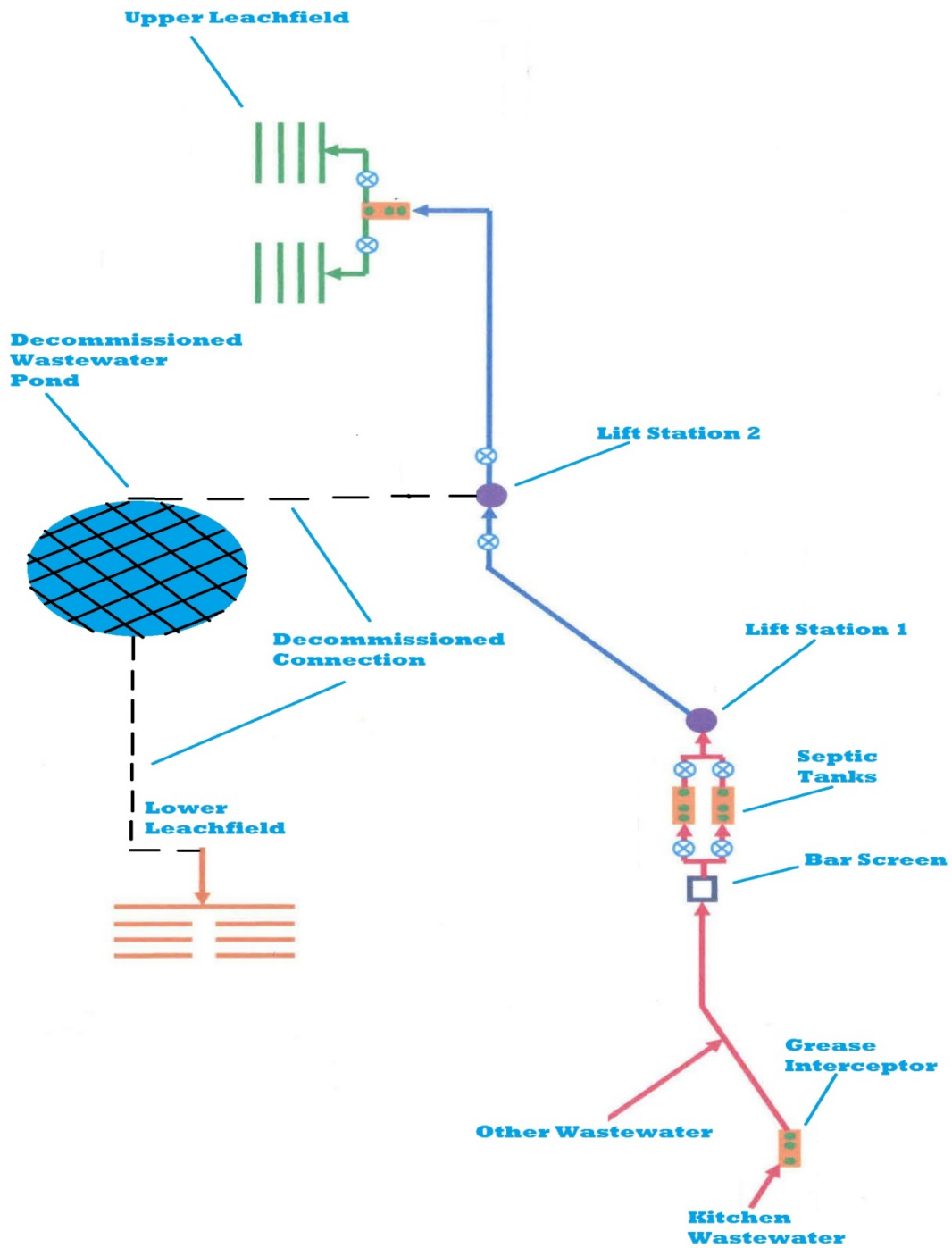


Table1, Summary of Facility Specific General Order Requirements (NOA Enclosure)

General Order Section	Page	Numeric Limitation	Requirement (refer to General Order and NOA for details)
A. PROHIBITIONS			
A.1-A.11	15	--	Prohibitions
B. REQUIREMENTS BY WASTEWATER SYSTEM TYPE			
B.1.a-B.1.l	16	--	All Wastewater Systems
B.1.a	16	14,200 gpd	Wastewater Flow Limit.
B.3.a-B.3.g	21	--	Aerobic Treatment Systems
B.6.a-B.6.h	24	--	Subsurface Disposal System
B.8.a-B.8.f	26	--	Sludge/Solids/Biosolids Disposal
C. GROUNDWATER AND SURFACE WATER LIMITATIONS			
C.1	27	--	Groundwater and Surface Water Limitations
D. EFFLUENT LIMITATIONS			
D.1.a	27	--	Five Day Biochemical Oxygen Demand (BOD ₅), monthly average.
D.1.a	27	--	Total Suspended Solids (TSS), monthly average.
E. PROVISIONS			
Technical Report Requirements			
E.1.a	28	Have on-site	Spill Prevention and Emergency Response Plan
E.1.b	29	Have on-site	Sampling and Analysis Plan
E.1.c	30	Not Applicable	Sludge Management Plan
E.2.h	32	Have on-site	Copy of NOA, and General Order